

Adobe patches Flash

Adobe pushed an update to its Flash player to address around seven vulnerabilities

Twitter protects WiFi users

Twitter has turned on the secure browsing capability ie. HTTPS by default to protect WiFi users

Security watch

Govt attacked, Anonymous lingers

Last month saw a bevy of activity in the World Wide Web's underbelly. Here's the gist

Nine government sites hit by cyber attacks: NIC

The National Informatics Center (NIC) has revealed that as many as nine government websites were defaced by recent cyber attacks. It further said that the servers, which host these government sites, suffer a number of hacking attempts on a daily basis.

The websites www.kumbh-2010haridwar.gov.in, www.ueppcb.uk.gov.in, www.gov.ua.nic.in/ujn, www.cdodoon.gov.in, www.arunachal.nic.in, www.bee-india.nic.in, www.civilsupplieskerala.gov.in, www.mpcb.gov.in and www.informatics.nic.in were defaced, prompting authorities to ramp up the cyber security safeguards.

In an RTI reply, the NIC, which reports to the Ministry of Communications and Information Technology, said that it was impossible for the body to accurately quantify these attacks but they are usually blocked by security controls put in place. The NIC says there was "no such compilation available" on the affected URLs and portals. "Source of an attempt is mostly traced through Internet protocol (IP) numbers making these attacks. However, the IP number may not be correct, since usually attackers attempt to masquerade their origin."

Anonymous hacks FTC's OnGuardOnline.gov site, promises more mayhem

Part of its continued protest against online piracy bills, ACTA/PIPA/SOPA, hacker

groups Anonymous and AntiSec Ops took down a U.S. government anti-scam website, OnGuardOnline.gov.

The FTC said that it had taken the site offline, and will keep it that way until they can secure it. The OnGuardOnline.gov website contains information from various U.S. government agencies, such as military and law enforcement. Anonymous hackers recently took out the DOJ, FBI, Universal Music Group, MPAA, RIAA, and U.S. Copyright office websites, calling it their single biggest strike till date.

Announcing the deed on pastebin, along with links to file dumps, Anonymous hackers said:



If SOPA/PIPA/ACTA passes we will wage a relentless war against the corporate internet, destroying dozens upon dozens of government and company websites. As you are reading this we are amassing our allied armies of darkness, preparing boatloads of stolen booty for our next raid. We are sitting on hundreds of rooted servers getting ready to drop all your mysql

dumps and mail spools. Your passwords? Your precious bank accounts? Even your online dating details?! You ain't even trying to step on this..

FBI wants an app to detect global and domestic threats

The FBI is in talks with developers to create an app that will notify them of suspicious behavior, combining information from Facebook, Twitter and Google Maps. The FBI has been monitoring user content on a lot of these sites for a while, and have lucked out in the past, catching many criminals who've unthinkingly revealed incriminating information.

"Social media has become a primary source of intelligence, because it has become the premier first response to key events and the primal alert to possible developing situations," according to the FBI.

The app will work as an early-warning system, allowing the FBI

to be alerted of any threats or crimes, with location information displayed on maps. The FBI's Strategic Information and Operations Center (SOIC), had put out a market research request for a "Social Media Application," in February, specifying the features required, including collecting open source information from

across the web on domestic and global terror data, automated search and scrape capability of social networks, and more.

Microsoft Store India hacked

Microsoft Store India has been hacked, by a group calling itself Chinese Evil Shadow Team. The site is not run by Microsoft, but Quasar Media, an Indian company responsible for its maintenance and operation. The website was taken down by Microsoft until it can be secured. The hackers have also leaked Microsoft Store India members' usernames and passwords, which horrifically enough, were stored in plain text.

The Chinese Evil Shadow Team is apparently a two-man team, who also managed to upload a page to deface the site. Microsoft India confirmed the attack, and sent out precautionary emails to members. The company reassured users that credit card details and payment information databases were not affected, however, other data may have been exposed, such as order details, and shipping addresses, apart from usernames, e-mail addresses, and passwords.

The company has asked users using the same e-mail and password combinations on any other sites to "proactively change the password immediately." Microsoft Store India will be sending an email with a temporary password and a prompt to create a new password. Users who receive the e-mail are requested to immediately create a new password. **4**